

TASKMASTER

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers #195 (May 1980)

REAL NAME Unknown

OCCUPATION Mercenary, teacher **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 220 lbs **EYES** / **HAIR** Not known

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Can copy other people's movements, regardless of complexity, after watching them once.

The Taskmaster committed several grand larcenies before establishing a series of academies to train criminals. When the Avengers realized this, they began closing his academies down. During a spell in prison, he trained a new CAPTAIN AMERICA: John Walker (see US AGENT).

The Taskmaster signed on to train recruits for the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9) at Camp Hammond, and he now leads its covert Shadow Initiative. **DW, MF**



TATTERDEMALION

FIRST APPEARANCE Werewolf by Night #9 (September 1973)

REAL NAME Arnold Pattonroth (alias Michael Wyatt)

OCCUPATION Tap-dancer, actor **BASE** Los Angeles

HEIGHT 5 ft 9 in **WEIGHT** 165 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Enhanced strength, speed; gloves treated with a solvent that dissolves paper and fabric; Kevlar body armor; cloak contains chloroform capsules; indestructible scarf.

Pattonroth was swindled of his life's savings by Las Vegas mobsters. He joined an army of derelicts on the streets of LA and declared war on the rich. Defeated by the WEREWOLF and SPIDER-MAN, he moved back to Las Vegas and attacked the criminals who had stolen from him. He later returned to LA and was recruited into the criminal organization Night Shift, run by the Shroud. During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5) he was forced to fight for the THUNDERBOLTS.

TD, MF



TAURUS

FIRST APPEARANCE The Avengers #72 (January 1970)

REAL NAME Cornelius Van Lunt

OCCUPATION Criminal mastermind **BASE** New York City

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 260 lbs **EYES** Brown **HAIR** Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Utilized Star-Blazer handgun, which fired blasts of stellar energy

Fascinated by astrology, multimillionaire Cornelius Van Lunt secretly founded the criminal organization ZODIAC to achieve political and economic domination of the world. Each of Zodiac's 12 leaders was named after his or her astrological sign and was based in a different American city: Van Lunt became Taurus, based in New York.

Both in his true identity and as Taurus, Van Lunt clashed with the AVENGERS. Van Lunt ended up battling MOON KNIGHT aboard a plane and died when it crashed. There have since been various other versions of the Zodiac organization, each with its own Taurus. **PS**



TEEN BRIGADE

The Teen Brigade was a group of teenaged shortwave radio enthusiasts, founded by Rick JONES to keep tabs on the HULK. By relaying possible sightings to the other members of their volunteer network, the group could often pin down the Hulk's location. It was the Teen Brigade's call for help that assembled the AVENGERS for the very first time, and the Teen Brigade later helped the newly-revived CAPTAIN AMERICA track down a suspect who had turned the Avengers to stone. The group acted as a precursor of sorts to Captain America's "Stars and Stripes" computer hotline network.

A second grouping of the Teen Brigade helped Rick Jones bring Bruce Banner and Betty Ross to the site of the original detonation site that turned Banner into the Hulk. The Corruptor derailed their mission, but he quickly met defeat and the Teen Brigade escaped without injury. **DW**

The Teen Brigade used short-wave radios and Internet-enabled computers to keep in touch with each other.



FACTFILE

MEMBERS

RICK JONES (founder), **CANDY RIDER**, **SPECS**, **WHEELS**, plus other unnamed volunteers.

BASE

Mobile

FIRST APPEARANCE

Incredible Hulk Vol. 1 #6 (March 1963)